



BEFORE YOU GET ONE...

**THE
TRUTH
ABOUT
UNCONVENTIONAL
PETS**

**6 Animals. Real Care Facts.
No Guesswork.**



🐾 Beginner-Friendly Guide 🐾

RABBIT



Adult Size
12+ in
(30+ cm)



Lifespan
10+ years



Difficulty
Intermediate



Monthly Cost
\$



Habitat

- Enclosure 4x rabbit's size
- Solid floor only (no wire)
- Needs a hiding spot



Feeding



CAN EAT

- ✓ Hay (unlimited)
- ✓ Rabbit pellets
- ✓ Leafy greens



AVOID

- Too much fruit



Handling

- Always support the full body
- Never lift by the ears



Health Warning

- Stops eating = emergency
- Lethargy
- Hunched posture



Beginner's #1 Mistake

Cage too small — needs at least 4x the rabbit's size.



GUINEA PIG



Adult Size
up to 12 in
(30 cm)



Lifespan
5-8 years



Difficulty
Beginner



Monthly Cost
\$



Habitat

- Min. 24 x 36 in cage
- Solid bottom
- Keep in pairs, not alone



Feeding



CAN EAT

- ✓ Hay (unlimited)
- ✓ Vitamin C pellets
- ✓ Fresh veggies



AVOID

- Pellets without Vitamin C



Handling

- Always support the full body
- Best kept with a companion



Health Warning

- Hair loss / bald patches
- Lethargy
- Sneezing or eye/nose discharge



Beginner's #1 Mistake

Cage too small — the #1 mistake new owners make.



IGUANA



Adult Size
up to 6+ FT
(2m)



Lifespan
up to 20
years



Difficulty
Advanced



Monthly Cost
\$\$\$



Habitat

- Starts in a small tank...
- ...but adults need a ROOM-sized enclosure
- Needs climbing branches (tree-dweller)



Baby / Juvenile
(small tank)



Adult
(room-sized enclosure)



Feeding



CAN EAT

- ✓ Leafy greens
- ✓ Chopped vegetables



AVOID

Any animal protein
or insects



Handling

- Handle daily from baby age
- Adult tail can injure — handle with caution



Health Warning

- Lethargy + body swelling
- Increased thirst/urination = kidney warning sign



Beginner's #1 Mistake

Buying a cute 8-inch baby without knowing it becomes a 6-foot giant that needs a whole room.



LEOPARD GECKO



Adult Size
up to 10 in
(25 cm)



Lifespan
15-20 years
long commitment!



Difficulty
Beginner-friendly

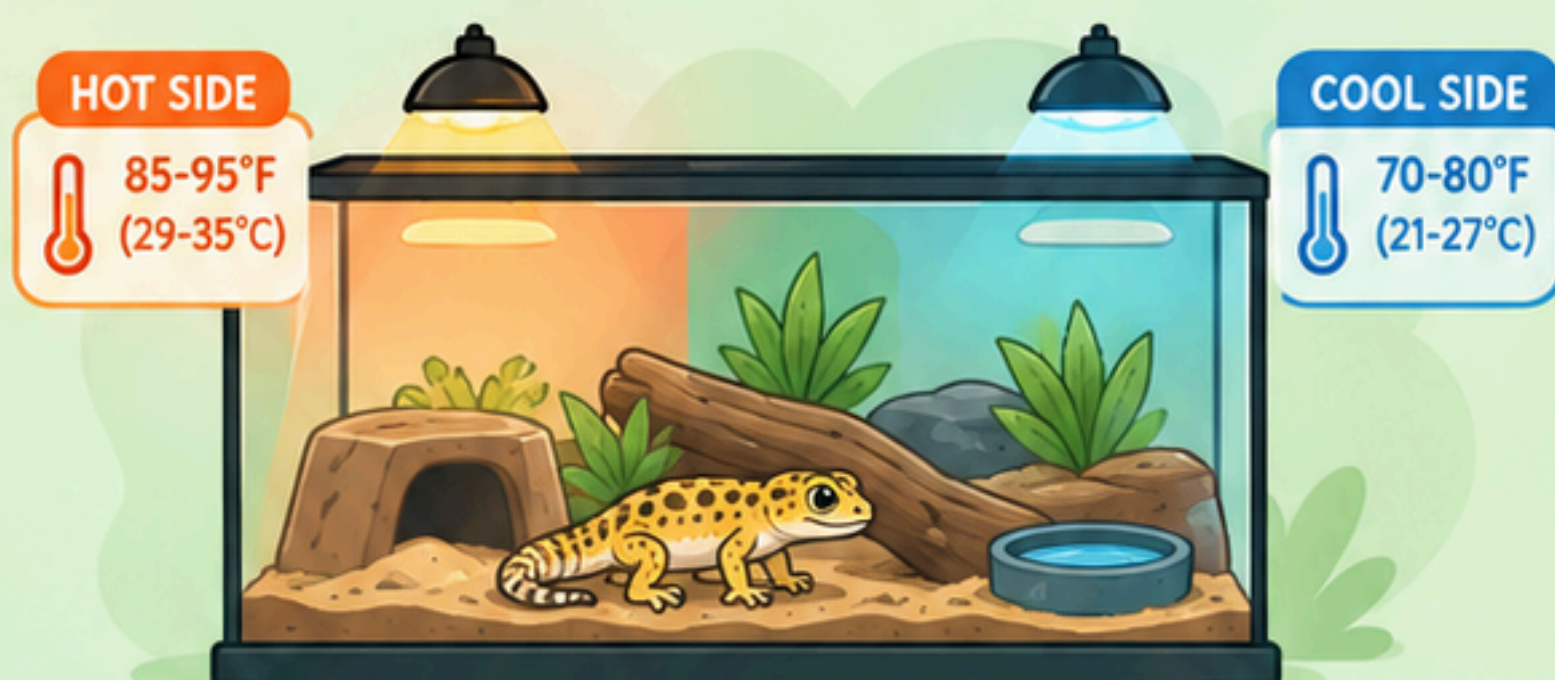


Monthly Cost
\$



Habitat

- 20+ gallon tank (adult)
- Warm side + cool side
- Humid hide for shedding



Feeding

✓ CAN EAT

- ✓ Crickets
- ✓ Mealworms
- ✓ Dubia roaches

+ calcium powder 2-3x/week

✗ AVOID

—



Handling

- Docile, easy to hold
- Never grab by the tail



Health Warning

- Refuses food 1+ week
- Stuck shed on toes/tail



Beginner's #1 Mistake

Wrong temperature gradient —
gecko can't digest food properly.



PET FROG

(White's Tree Frog)



Adult Size
3-5 in
(7-13 cm)



Lifespan
7-10 years
(up to 20)



Difficulty
Beginner



Monthly Cost
\$



Habitat

- Min. 15-20 gallon tank
- Humid substrate
- Climbing branches



Feeding



CAN EAT



Crickets



Roaches

(size-appropriate insects)



Handling

- Minimal handling
- Always wash hands first — no lotion or soap



Health Warning

- Lethargy
- Skin discoloration
- Refuses food



Beginner's #1 Mistake

Handling too much or with chemicals on hands — their skin absorbs everything.



TORTOISE



Adult Size

6-30+ in

depending on species



Lifespan

40-100+ years

may outlive you!



Difficulty

Beginner to Advanced

(species-dependent)



Monthly Cost

\$ to \$\$\$



Habitat

- Dry substrate
- UVB lighting is essential
- Giant species need outdoor space



Small species
(indoor enclosure)



Giant species
(outdoor pen)



Feeding



CAN EAT

- ✓ Leafy greens
- ✓ Weeds



AVOID

- ✗ Too much fruit



Handling

- Minimal handling needed
- Solitary by nature — respect their space



Health Warning

- Appetite change
- Shell damage/soft spots
- Abnormal droppings



Beginner's #1 Mistake

Choosing the wrong species for your space — a Sulcata looks small but becomes a 100+ lb giant.

